LVNA
EST 1958

# VILLAGER

VOLUME 64 EDITION 09 SEPTEMBER 2021 REPRESENTING 1,614 HOUSEHOLDS

## WHAT'S IN THIS ISSUE

1 next meeting
water conservation

3 ca gubernatorial recall election

4 the checkered history of lakewood village

8 meet your neighbor

9 scavenger hunt

11 lvna meeting recap
lvna picnic canceled

## NEXT MEETING

Join us for a virtual discussion on September 8th when we welcome back Dr. Moshe Lewis, M.D. to share updates on the COVID-19 Delta variant, vaccinations, and the return to work/school. In addition to being a practicing physician in San Carlos, holding a master's in Public Health, along with his M.D., he's also a parent of two school-age children who can relate to any concerns you may have about your own kids.
Join us on Wednesday to take advantage of this great opportunity to have your questions answered.

**Wednesday, September 8th, 7:00 – 8:00 PM**

Zoom meeting credentials will be posted to LVNASV.org/meeting one hour before the start of the meeting.

## WATER CONSERVATION

As a reminder to our neighbors, a Stage 2 water supply shortage was declared by the Sunnyvale City Council on July 27. The goal is for Sunnyvale to reduce our water usage by 15% (this is measured relative to 2020 water usage). To help achieve this reduction, Sunnyvale residents can water lawns and gardens on assigned days each week:

- Houses with an **odd-numbered** street address or without a number can water on **Mondays, Thursdays, and Saturdays**
- Houses with an **even-numbered** street address can water on **Tuesdays, Fridays, and Sundays**

Sunnyvale also has permanent water restrictions in place, which you can find at https://qcode.us/codes/sunnyvale/view.php?topic=12-12_34-12_34_020

Did you know:

All of California is in a moderate drought (D1) and 88% of California (including Sunnyvale) is in an extreme drought (D3).[1]

As of July 2021, the Lexington Reservoir water level was 20-25% of capacity.[2]

Toilets built before 1982 use 5-7 gallons of water per flush. Modern toilets are required by federal law to use no more than 1.6 gallons of water per flush.[3] Want to know how much your toilet uses? Check its tank or base - you'll see a number and "gpf" (e.g., "1.28 gpf," where gpf stands for "gallons per flush").[4]

---

References:

[1] https://www.drought.gov/states/california

[2] https://www.paloaltoonline.com/news/2021/07/09/state-expands-drought-emergency-to-santa-clara-san-mateo-counties

[3] https://www.home-water-works.org/indoor-use/toilets

[4] https://homeguides.sfgate.com/many-gallons-water-flush-toilet-88812.html


CUTTING EDGE
LAWN CARE AND LANDSCAPING

Miguel Rios
650-810-6893

I offer landscaping services including fences, concrete, pavers, house interior and exterior. Prices are reasonable. I live locally and would love the support!




# CA GUBERNATORIAL RECALL ELECTION

**SEPTEMBER 14**

The deadline to vote in the California gubernatorial recall election - to vote on whether or not Governor Newsom gets to keep his seat and, if he doesn't, who should replace him - is September 14. You can vote in person - both early voting and day-of voting are available. All registered and active voters in California should have received a ballot in the mail as well. Those ballots can be dropped off at a secure dropbox (no later than 8:00pm on September 14) or mailed, free of charge, through USPS. Mailed ballots must be postmarked by September 14 in order to be counted. You can find early voting locations and ballot dropbox locations at https://caearlyvoting.sos.ca.gov/

There are two questions on the ballot. You can answer both questions or just one question. The first question asks, "Shall GAVIN NEWSOM be recalled (removed) from the office of Governor?" Vote yes if you want him to be recalled, vote no if you want him to keep his job. In order to remain governor, a majority (>50%) of voters must vote "no" on this question.

The second question asks you to pick someone (or write in the name of someone) who should replace Newsom, assuming that a majority of voters vote to recall him. If you choose to write-in someone, keep in mind that Gavin Newsom is ineligible (it won't count). California law makes it illegal for the incumbent to be the replacement candidate. If Newsom is recalled, then the replacement candidate will be the person who gets the most votes on the second question. In other words, the replacement candidate only needs to get the most votes - they do not need to win a majority.

If Newsom is recalled, the new governor will be in office through the rest of Newsom's term (until January 2, 2023). The recall election is estimated to cost taxpayers roughly $275 million.

The last day to register to vote was August 30. However, if you missed this voter registration deadline, you can submit a Conditional Voter Registration form. See these resources for more information:
https://sccvote.sccgov.org/elections/september-14-2021-california-gubernatorial-recall-election
https://www.sos.ca.gov/elections/voter-registration/same-day-reg

As a final reminder, while the election is September 14, we will likely not know the result of the election on September 14. Similar to the 2020 presidential election, a large number of mail-in ballots are expected, which will need to be counted before the results are finalized. If the recall is successful, the new governor will be sworn in 38 days after the recall.

Did you know:
Governor Newsom was elected with 61.9% of the vote in 2018.
There have been 55 attempts since 1911 to recall a governor in California. Only one of those (in 2003) was successful, when Arnold Schwarzenegger replaced then-Governor Gray Davis.

References
https://www.sos.ca.gov/elections/upcoming-elections/2021-ca-gov-recall/newsom-recall-faqs
https://www.nytimes.com/article/newsom-recall-election-voter-guide.html
https://ballotpedia.org/Gavin_Newsom_recall,_Governor_of_California_(2019-2021)

# THE CHECKERED HISTORY OF LAKEWOOD VILLAGE

**Thank you to Katharina Woodman, at the Sunnyvale Historical Society, who kindly researched and wrote this article for us.**

**(1956 – early 2000s)**

Before anyone could even dream of a development to be called Lakewood Village, the City of Sunnyvale had to define the city's borders. During the 1950s, annexation wars were raging in the area between Cupertino, Sunnyvale, Santa Clara, and San José. Cupertino attempted incorporation in 1954 in order to avoid being swallowed up by Sunnyvale and San José. Santa Clara and Sunnyvale engaged in litigation over land along Lawrence Station Road which, Santa Clara claimed, "illegally spilled into Santa Clara territory". Sunnyvale was eager to secure Lockheed and General Motors to build factories in the city and had earmarked parcels of land for those companies. Mountain View protested the annexation of land set aside for Lockheed by Sunnyvale. In 1956, there were nineteen different annexation proceedings involving the City of Sunnyvale and their neighbors. Eventually, the city lost General Motors to Fremont, but the relocation of Lockheed proceeded as planned, when land was annexed north of Highway 101 and on either side of Lawrence Station Road (now Lawrence Expressway).

By 1956, Sunnyvale had attracted so many major companies that people flocked to the city in search of employment. Among others, Lockheed had relocated here, an area described by an employee as "all beanfields then, and the Bayshore Freeway was only a two-lane road." The last traffic light on the Bayshore Freeway between San Francisco and San José, at Fair Oaks, was removed in 1960. The city of just under 10,000 inhabitants in 1950 would grow to 53,000 citizens by 1960.

In 1956, the new development of Lakewood Village advertised inexpensive homes for Lockheed and military personnel, with no down payment necessary for veterans. It was to consist of 1,732 small single-family homes in "Eichler-esque" style. The area was laid out between Highway 101 to the south, Tasman Drive to the north, Calabasas Creek to the east, and Fair Oaks Avenue to the west, but it was bisected by Lawrence Station Road. Branden Construction Company boasted they were "building the homes of tomorrow in Sunnyvale". Though smaller than houses in other areas of the city, the homes found buyers very quickly: young families moved into the two- and three- bedroom houses. The neighborhood quickly formed a strong sense of community, when families helped each other out with babysitting and shopping. Major attractions were neighborhood parties for the Fourth of July, barbecues, and block parties, where children were allowed to light their own sparklers. Parents got together for card games and social events while children played out in the yards and in the street. Holidays were celebrated together with families taking turns hosting them.

From the beginning, though, residents felt ignored by the City and like a "stepchild," compared to other parts of Sunnyvale. Services were not at the same level, and residents had to fight for amenities, such as a nearby fire station. In order to stand united, the residents formed the Lakewood Village Residents' Association in 1958. They started a newsletter, named The Villager, and held social events. During its existence until the mid-1970s,


Integrum
Construction

Over 35 years of combined experience!

Maximize the value of your home by adding a legal Accessible Dwelling Unit!
Refresh your bathroom or kitchen!
Modernize your exterior or floor plan!
Located in Sunnyvale. We are neighbors!
Specializing in value-engineered design and construction!
Nervous about getting started? Call us or visit us online!

Sergio@integrumgc.com | 925.895.7898 | www.Integrumgc.com

the association brought about several changes, including the building of a fire station, avoiding the construction of a slaughterhouse, and keeping land earmarked for the creation of Fairwood Park instead of more housing. Having to cross Lawrence Expressway in order to make it to Lakewood Park enticed some mothers to petition for a green space on the east side of the highway, which later was expanded to include a playground.

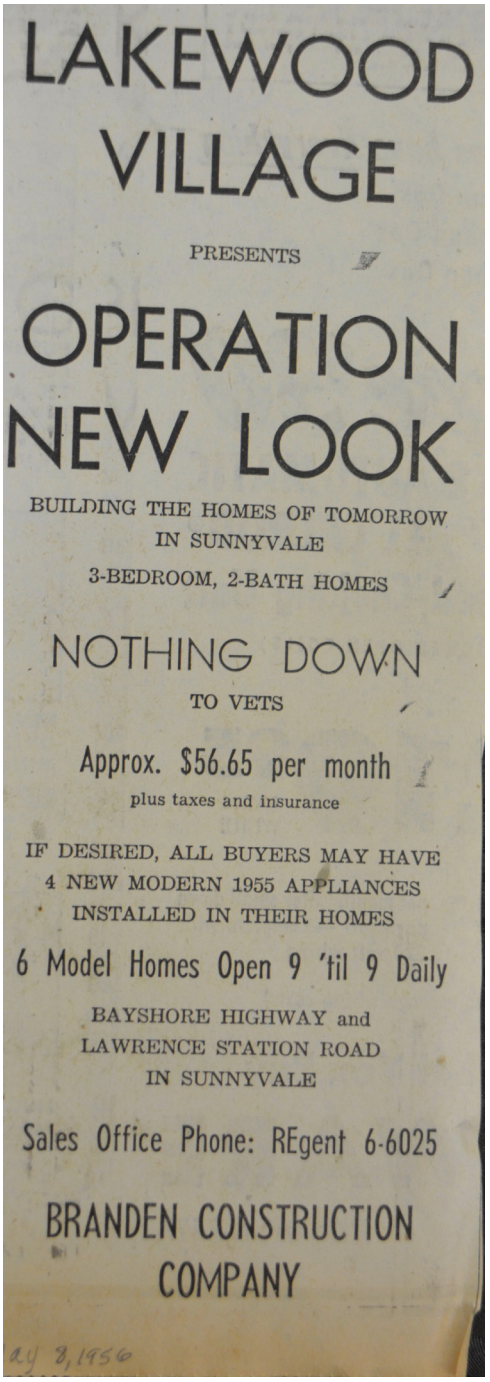
Beginning in the 1960s, demographics changed in the community; families who had outgrown the small homes moved away into bigger ones elsewhere and military personnel, posted to other parts of the country, led to an ever-changing population. Since many of the original owners kept their houses and rented them out, the percentage of renters increased. At the same time, the number of families declined when single people moved into the small homes. The cohesiveness of the neighborhood broke up, children grew up and moved out, new families didn't participate in social events, and children didn't play together outside anymore.

A 1968 census indicated a moderate income level in the Lakewood Village population, as well as good education. However, the survey also revealed there was no sense of community pride. As a result, a grant was requested to study the reason for the rapid turnover in residents which contributed to a lack of "natural leaders."

Lawrence Expressway was extended to run from Mountain View-Alviso Road all the way south to Quito Road in Saratoga, a total of 8.1 miles. When a proposal was made in 1972 to widen the roadway, residents expressed their concern over reduced pedestrian walkways and bike routes. The same year, residents rejected a plan for more low-income housing to be built for fear of overcrowding schools. Complaints of overcrowding and rowdyism reached a new height when a 13-year-old student was killed riding his bike home from school. The student had preferred to cycle in order to avoid the school bus where he was being bullied.

An emergence of gangs in the 1970s led to complaints from Lakewood residents that the public safety department wasn't keeping the neighborhood safe. Homeowners would stay in their garages during remodels in order to protect building materials from being stolen. The appearance of the neighborhood was declining: garages were turned into living spaces without permits, derelict cars were left out in the road, and trash accumulated. Homes became sites for illegal businesses and renters failed to take care of the general upkeep of houses and yards. There was a much higher occurrence of code violations in this part of town than elsewhere. Potential home buyers were turned off by the appearance of the community, so everyone's home value decreased. It was rumored that the safety department did not enforce fines because residents could not afford to pay for the improvements or the fines.

The local shopping center fell into disrepair due to juvenile vandalism and neglect. The residents demanded a facelift and started working with owner Gene Lee to improve conditions in 1975. When Mission College planned to build a 15-story unit adjacent to Lakewood in 1984, residents again rallied and protested, claiming that the building would cast a shadow on the houses next to it and traffic would be increased, as was the case with moviegoers who raced through the village to make it to the Mercado Theater in time. Although voter turnout and civic engagement were low, residents would organize and fight for a cause together. The additional widening of Lawrence Expressway in 1986 in order to add carpool lanes between Highway 237 and Prospect Road was such a cause; cyclists demanded bike access, bike lanes, and crossings or overpasses.




*The flier is the original advertisement for the new development and was posted in the Sunnyvale Standard (May 1956), courtesy of SHS archives.*

When a local student was the victim of severe burns, community members proved once again that they would take up a cause together. The neighbors helped the victim's family in multiple ways, giving back to the family who had done so much for the community, including the fostering of "wayward children" and organizing youth baseball and football leagues. In appreciation for all they had done in the past, their neighbors now took care of the family in need.

In March of 1988, a 30-year-old three-bedroom house in Lakewood Park was priced at $150,000. Over the decades, rising house prices and rents pushed residents out of the area, leading to more deterioration.

In 1991, a new organization was formed: the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association. In an attempt to deal with the lack of property upkeep, The Villager newsletter prompted outrage when it posted a list, five houses each, of the most well-kept and the ugliest. Neighbors perceived the accusations as unfair, because not everyone could afford to paint their house or make the necessary upgrades.

In the early 2000s, the story of Lakewood seemed to come full circle, with a diverse population of young families again moving in and an increase in community spirit. Once again, children played with each other as they had in the early days of the development. The famous Lakewood Holiday Parade had been reinstated, and families lined the streets to cheer on floats and Santa Claus. Homeowners outdid themselves decorating their houses for the holidays, literally lighting up the neighborhood.

As part of a new partnership with the City, "Dumpster Days" were introduced in 2000 as part of a general attempt to clean up the neighborhood and help residents who couldn't afford improvements. Twenty-one dumpsters were placed throughout the village during the summer, with neighbors coming together to help each other by carting away unwanted items. This new community/City cooperation paid off and led to a transformation of the village. When statistics indicated the highest numbers of code violations in the city were occurring in Lakewood Village, a dedicated staff member was assigned to help in a concerted effort to clean up one area at a time. Ninety-five homes on Lakehaven Drive and Lakeknoll Drive were targeted, and City staff approached every home with personnel who spoke Spanish, Vietnamese, English, and Tagalog. Fifty-three of those homes were improved with corrections of code violations, including fixing garages, patios, and roof conversions, and removing overgrown vegetation. Several houses received new coats of paint with free paint provided by the City, new driveways were installed or old ones restored, and cars no longer cluttered the streets. After that success, the City decided to keep the improvement plan in the budget, to be known as the Neighborhood Enhancement Program and extend it to more streets. Residents reported new opportunities to talk to neighbors when everybody was bringing discarded items to the dumpsters and encountering people they had never seen before.



In 2003, it was the most diverse neighborhood in the city, with a population of Latino, Filipino, Vietnamese, and Caucasian residents. Latinos and Asians were the biggest group, with Caucasians making up 35%.

Lakewood Village has been set apart from the rest of the city, not just by its odd geography, but by demographics and the higher rate of resident turnover. In times of crisis, though, neighbors have pulled together to stand up for their rights and their community, whatever the mix of ethnicity and social status.



*Pictures 1 and 2 are photos of Lakewood Park, taken by Maria Pease (April 1985), courtesy Sunnyvale Historical Society.*

## ADVERTISE WITH US!

We have space throughout the Villager to host ads of various sizes. If you're interested in advertising with us, please email us at ads@lvnasv.org

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE
SAME PRICE. GREAT SERVICE.

**ALL SERVICE CENTER**

**NOTARY, APOSTILLE, MAIL BOXES, PASSPORT PHOTOS & MORE**

530 LAWRENCE EXPY
SUNNYVALE, CA 94085
WWW.NOTARY4ALL.COM

M-F 8:30 - 7:00
SAT 10:00 - 1:30
(408)736-0313
(408)470-3002



DO YOU WANT TO FIND OUT WHAT YOUR HOME IS WORTH?

Ask Grace Keng Realtor
also Lakewood Homeowner

408-799-8887

kw

dre: 00919545


*The views, opinions, and facts presented in the Villager are of their respective authors/creators and don't necessarily reflect the views or opinions of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association, its officers, residents or other sponsors.*
*If you'd like to submit an article, event, etc., for possible publication in a future edition of the Villager, please send an email to our editor(s) at editor@lvnasv.org*

# MEET YOUR NEIGHBOR

Please email vp2@lvnasv.org if you want to recommend someone for an upcoming newsletter or if you would like to interview a neighbor for the newsletter.

## MICHELLE N.

Q: Tell me a bit about yourself and your family.

Michelle: I came to the United States as a refugee at the end of 1984. In order to support my college education in Seattle, I worked as a morning newspaper carrier and hotel's housekeeper.

Q: When did you move to the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood?

Michelle: I moved to the Bay Area in 1989, after graduation, to work for several high-tech companies.

Q: What street do you live on?

Michelle: Twinlake Dr.

Q: Name one thing you see out your kitchen window.

Michelle: My backyard is empty with only two fruit trees. From my kitchen window, I only see the sky with many cable wires. My favorite moment is when a few birds stand on the cable singing and swinging.

Q: Something that is in your front yard?

Michelle: My front yard is also empty (shame on me :-) )

Q: A sound you hear frequently in the neighborhood?

Michelle: I frequently hear freeway and airplane sounds when I am in my backyard. At night, sometimes I hear the trains.

Q: What is something you like about living in Lakewood/Fairwood?

Michelle: I love the village and everyone around me. It is so peaceful. And I know I have my neighbors to count on in case of emergency.

Q: And something that has changed since you moved to the neighborhood?

Michelle: A lot has changed since I moved to the neighborhood in 2002. Many people have remodeled their homes, and the houses look newer.



Q: What are your favorite parks/things to do in Sunnyvale and/or the Bay Area?

Michelle: I love walking in our Lakewood Park and hiking in the city/state parks. My favorite hiking place is Foothills Nature Preserve

Q: Tell me a bit about your hobbies.

Michelle: My hobbies were swimming, scuba diving, wind surfing, skiing and snowboarding, but I'm not doing those lately because I am getting older.

Q: Any great stories to share about living in the neighborhood?

Michelle: My neighbor is a young professional who does not like to take care of flowers. During the pandemic, I convinced him to take care of my orchid. Whenever my orchid blooms, I will lend him the flowers and show him how to water it so that the flowers can last at least 3 months.

# NEIGHBORHOOD SCAVENGER HUNT

Congratulations to Mar J. on the Fairwood side! Mar was the winner of the August scavenger hunt and received a $10 gift card to a local restaurant.

Welcome to the monthly scavenger hunt. Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to vp2@lvnasv.org by September 30, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. The winner will get to choose from either a selection of $10 gift cards to local restaurants OR a toy from our toy prize chest.

1. True or False: At the intersection of Silverlake Dr and Lakebird Dr, the fire hydrant is at the southwest corner.
   (a) True
   (b) False

2. What is the Fairwood Elementary School mascot?
   (a) Owls
   (b) Eagles
   (c) Raptors
   (d) Falcons

3. There's a mural at Lakewood Park near the basketball courts. Which of these things is included on the mural?
   (a) Bicycle
   (b) Rainbow
   (c) Baseball mitt
   (d) All of the above

4. Which of the following is NOT true about the upcoming California gubernatorial recall election?
   (a) The election is September 14
   (b) In order to keep his job, Governor Newsom has to win a majority (>50%) of the votes
   (c) The ballot consists of three questions (if Newsom should be recalled, who should succeed him if he is recalled, and if the capital should be moved from Sacramento to Redding)
   (d) If Newsom is recalled, the new governor will be the candidate who gets the most votes on the second question

5. On the Crestwood Court cul-de-sac, how many houses have garages?
   (a) All of them
   (b) All but one house
   (c) All but three houses
   (d) All but five houses

**Answers from the June scavenger hunt:**

1. What is the Lakewood Elementary School mascot?
   (a) Lakewood Lions

2. Which of the following is true about Sunnyvale's FoodCycle program?
   (a) The program

3. The City of Sunnyvale is current re-drawing the boundaries of its six Council districts, a process called redistricting. The City is using the results from which Census for the redistricting?
   (b) 2020

4. There is a bus stop at the corner of Bridgewood Way and Burntwood Way.
   (b) False

5. At the intersection of Socorro Ave and Fairwood Ave, the street sign is on which corner?
   (d) Northwest

## Instyle Beauty Salon, located in Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, is offering readers $150 off microblading, a new and popular procedure that creates the perfect eyebrow!

Normally $450, Instyle Beauty Salon is offering readers $150 off, making it just $300 for the procedure – which also includes the touch-up visit that is recommended within 4-6 weeks of the initial procedure.

Manual microblading is a form of a semi-permanent tattoo that involves using tiny needles (instead of a tattoo gun) that make up a small blade to help deposit pigment under your skin, one by one, for natural looking hair strokes. The procedure takes about an hour to 2 hours and lasts 1.5-2 years before needing to be redone to look fresh. Topical numbing cream is used to maximize comfort. Microblading is perfect for anyone with any hair color and is tailored to each individual client.

For more information and to schedule a consultation, call or text (408) 605-2146.










## LVNA CONTACTS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| President | Lydia Fotiades | president@lvnasv.org |
| 1st VP | Tony Bugna | vp1@lvnasv.org |
| 2nd VP | Cortney Jansen | vp2@lvnasv.org |
| Treasurer | Bev Woidyla | treasurer@lvnasv.org |
| Secretary | Brad Dux | secretary@lvnasv.org |
| Newsletter | Ray Family | editor@lvnasv.org |
| Media | Ray Family | media@lvnasv.org |
| Advertising | Tony | ads@lvnasv.org |

## IMPORTANT NUMBERS

| | |
|---|---|
| Emergency | 911 |
| Abandoned Vehicles | (408) 730-7150 |
| Shopping Carts and Graffiti | (408) 730-7680 |
| Animal Control | (408) 730-7178 |
| Neighborhood Preservation | (408) 730-7610 |
| Parks & Maintenance | (408) 730-7506 |
| Public Safety -- General Info | (408) 730-7100 |
| Public Safety -- Non-Emergency | (408) 730-7180 |

# LVNA MEETING RECAP

### LVNA MEETING ON AUGUST 11

Last month, we had guest speakers come to discuss the Sunnyvale redistricting project. Guests included:

- Omar Din – District 6 city council member
- Jacqui Guzman – Deputy City Manager in charge of the redistricting project
- Frances Stanley-Jones – City Redistricting Commission Member
- Judy Pavlick – Founder of the Sunnyvale Mobile Home Park Alliance (SMHPA)

The outcome of this redistricting effort has a direct impact on our neighborhood and city for the next 10 years. If you weren't able to attend the meeting, or just want a refresher, we encourage you to check out the meeting recording to see how you can get involved in the process.

https://youtu.be/tBgnbymFMzg

# LVNA PICNIC CANCELED

To help keep our neighborhood safe, we've decided to cancel the LVNA picnic again this year.

# UPCOMING EVENTS

## SEPTEMBER

08 — lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

## OCTOBER

13 — lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

For all Sunnyvale events, please refer to Sunnyvale's online calendar at https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/cals/.